that he was a successful soldier or a conqueror hardly comes out in the stories. That emphasis on the goodness and self-sacrificing nature of the man is characteristic of the Indian mind and of Indian ideals. Vikramaditya's name, like that of Caesar, became a kind of symbol and title, and numerous subsequent rulers added it to their names. This has added to the Confusion, as there are many Vikramadityas mentioned in history.

But who was this Vikram? And when did he exist? Historically speaking everything is vague. There is no trace of any such ruler round about 57 **B.C**. when the Vikram Samvat era should begin. There was, however, a Vikramaditya in North India in the fourth century **A.C**., and he fought against H u n invaders and pushed them out. It is he who is supposed to have kept the 'nine

gems' in his court and around whom all these stories gather.

The problem then is this: How is this Vikramaditya who existed in the fourth century **A.C**. to be connected with an era which begins in 57 **B.C.** ? The probable explanation appears to be that an era dating from 57 **B.C.** existed in the Malava State in Central India, and, long after Vikram, this era and calendar were connected